

Portfolio Database Setup Guide (XAMPP / WAMP / MAMP / Linux)

This guide helps you fix “**Database connection failed**” for this project.

1) Quick Start (Recommended)

1. Start your web server + MySQL service.
 2. Open:
 - `http://localhost/portfolio/check-db.php`
 - `http://localhost/portfolio/setup/install.php`
 3. In installer, test credentials and run setup.
 4. Open homepage:
 - `http://localhost/portfolio/`
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2) XAMPP Setup (Step-by-Step)

Windows

1. Install XAMPP from <https://www.apachefriends.org>
2. Copy project folder to:
 - `C:\xampp\htdocs\portfolio`
3. Open **XAMPP Control Panel** and start:
 - Apache
 - MySQL
4. Visit installer:
 - `http://localhost/portfolio/setup/install.php`

macOS

1. Install XAMPP.
2. Copy project to:
 - `/Applications/XAMPP/xamppfiles/htdocs/portfolio`
3. Start Apache + MySQL from XAMPP Manager.
4. Open:
 - `http://localhost/portfolio/setup/install.php`

Linux

1. Install XAMPP or use native Apache + MySQL/MariaDB.
 2. Place project in web root (example):
 - `/opt/lampp/htdocs/portfolio` (XAMPP)
 - `/var/www/html/portfolio` (native Apache)
 3. Start services and run installer URL.
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3) Common Credentials to Try

- root + (empty password)
- root + root

Installer auto-tests common combinations and shows PASS/FAIL.

4) Manual Terminal Commands (if needed)

Check MySQL status

Linux (systemd)

```
sudo systemctl status mysql
# or
sudo systemctl status mariadb
```

XAMPP (Linux)

```
sudo /opt/lampp/lampp status
sudo /opt/lampp/lampp startmysql
```

macOS (Homebrew MySQL)

```
brew services list | grep mysql
brew services start mysql
```

Connect to MySQL manually

```
mysql -u root -p
# or (empty password)
mysql -u root
```

Create database manually

```
CREATE DATABASE IF NOT EXISTS portfolio_db
CHARACTER SET utf8mb4
COLLATE utf8mb4_unicode_ci;
```

Import schema/data manually

```
mysql -u root -p portfolio_db < /path/to/portfolio/database/portfolio.sql
# or with empty password:
mysql -u root portfolio_db < /path/to/portfolio/database/portfolio.sql
```

5) Troubleshooting

Error: Connection refused

- MySQL is not running.
- Start MySQL service from XAMPP/WAMP/MAMP or OS service manager.
- Verify host/port (127.0.0.1:3306).

Error: Access denied for user 'root'

- Wrong password.
- Try root with empty password, then root/root .
- Reset root password if needed.

Error: Unknown database 'portfolio_db'

- Database has not been created.
- Run installer or create/import manually.

Error still persists

- Open check-db.php and verify diagnostics.
- Update includes/db.php (or environment vars DB_HOST , DB_PORT , DB_NAME , DB_USER , DB_PASS).

6) Screenshot Placeholders

- [Screenshot 1: XAMPP Control Panel with Apache/MySQL running]
- [Screenshot 2: check-db.php PASS results]
- [Screenshot 3: setup/install.php success message]
- [Screenshot 4: phpMyAdmin database list showing portfolio_db]

7) After Setup

1. Visit http://localhost/portfolio/
2. Test login page and project listing.
3. If needed, clear browser cache and re-run check-db.php .